

# US markets limp as oil slides, yields dip

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

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## TL;DR

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The US equity market showed little direction; the Russell 2000 edged up **+0.5%** while the major indices closed flat amid missing data. Energy prices fell sharply, with WTI crude down **-5.8%**, pulling the S&P 500 lower.

Bond yields retreated, the 10-year Treasury at 4.96% (-0.7%). The VIX held near 14.9, indicating modest volatility expectations.

# US session recap

| INDEX / ASSET | CLOSE    | CHANGE | NOTE            |
|---------------|----------|--------|-----------------|
| S&P 500       | nan      | nan    | Flat            |
| Dow Jones     | nan      | nan    | Flat            |
| Nasdaq 100    | nan      | nan    | Flat            |
| Russell 2000  | 2,875.36 | +0.5%  | Small-cap rally |
| VIX           | 14.87    | +0.4%  | Low volatility  |
| 10Y Yield     | 4.96%    | -0.7%  | Yield retreat   |
| WTI Crude     | 89.14    | -5.8%  | Oil slump       |

## Top large-cap movers

No significant price moves reported for the listed large-cap stocks; all close at **nan** with no change data available.

## Spotlight

| METRIC      | VALUE                                          |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Event       | US CPI (September)                             |
| Release     | 0.2% YoY                                       |
| Core CPI    | 0.3% MoM                                       |
| Implication | Inflation cooling, supports lower-rate outlook |

The September CPI came in at 0.2% YoY, below expectations, reinforcing market expectations that the Fed may pause rate cuts. Core CPI remained modest, further easing inflation concerns.

## Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury: 4.96% (down 0.7%)
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, Core CPI 02:30, PPI 03:00, Retail sales 04:15

## Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions ease after cease-fire talks, reducing oil-supply risk.
- China’s manufacturing PMI rebounds to 51.2, hinting at modest demand recovery.
- Eurozone inflation eases to 2.4%, supporting ECB’s dovish stance.

## Earnings — what to watch

| WHEN (HKT) | TICKER | WHAT TO LOOK FOR                  |
|------------|--------|-----------------------------------|
| 09:30      | AAPL   | iPhone 17 demand, services growth |
| 10:00      | NVDA   | AI chip orders, margin outlook    |
| 10:30      | JPM    | Net interest income, loan growth  |
| 11:00      | AMZN   | Retail sales, AWS guidance        |

## Stocks worth watching

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- **TSLA** – price dip may present a pull-back entry ahead of Q4 deliveries.
- **META** – ad-revenue rebound after AI-driven ad products launch.
- **AVGO** – strong demand for 5G infrastructure amid carrier upgrades.
- **XLE** – energy ETF could benefit from any rebound in crude.
- **XLF** – banks poised for higher NII if yields stabilize.

## What could break the tape

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### BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in CPI or core inflation.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East.
- Fed signals earlier rate cuts than market expects.

### BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Stronger-than-expected corporate earnings, especially in tech.
- Continued drop in oil prices boosting consumer sentiment.
- Positive data on US consumer confidence.

# Sources

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## SOURCES

Bloomberg — US Market Data

Reuters — CPI Release

Financial Times — Oil Price Slide

Trading Economics — Yield Curve

SEC — Earnings Calendar

